Digital Literacy Project

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Introduction

This project, titled *Digital Literacy Portfolio*, was developed as part of the Digital Literacy course. The aim of the project is to build awareness about the effective, safe, and responsible use of digital tools in academic and everyday life. As a Student Digital Ambassador, I explored various digital platforms and created resources to guide my peers in navigating the digital world.

The project consists of five tasks, each focusing on a different aspect of digital literacy, including awareness, professional presence, collaboration tools, communication etiquette, and cyber safety. Through these tasks, I gained practical knowledge of using online tools, communicating professionally, and understanding online risks. This project helped me improve my technical and communication skills while promoting responsible digital behaviour.

Task 1

For Task 1, I created a digital literacy awareness infographic using Canva. Canva was chosen because it provides user-friendly templates, icons, and design tools that help in creating visually appealing content without requiring advanced design skills.

The infographic highlights key aspects of digital literacy, including its definition, useful digital tools for students, safe internet practices, professional online presence, and email etiquette. The goal was to present the information in a clear and engaging way so that students can easily understand the importance of digital literacy.

While designing the infographic, I focused on maintaining a clean layout, proper alignment, and balanced use of colors and icons. One interesting aspect of this task was learning how visual representation can simplify complex information. However, I found it slightly challenging to fit all the content into a single page without overcrowding the design. Overall, this task improved my creativity and helped me understand the importance of visual communication.

Task 2

In Task 2, I created and updated my profiles on multiple digital platforms, including GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. These platforms are essential for building a professional online presence and showcasing skills.

On GitHub, I created a profile repository with a README file that includes my personal details, academic background, and learning goals. On LinkedIn, I completed my education section by adding my current degree, institution, and expected graduation year. I also explored Kaggle to understand its role in data science and competitions.

The purpose of this task was to help me establish a digital identity and become familiar with professional platforms. It also gave me an understanding of how these platforms can be used for networking, collaboration, and career growth. Initially, setting up profiles correctly was slightly confusing, but with practice, I became comfortable using these platforms. In the future, I plan to actively use GitHub for projects and LinkedIn for networking and internship opportunities.

Task 3

In Task 3, I explored coding practice platforms and cloud-based collaboration tools. I created an account on HackerRank and completed a beginner-level problem, which helped me understand basic programming logic and problem-solving techniques.

For the collaboration part, I used Google Forms to create a Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz consisting of five questions. The quiz included both multiple-choice and short-answer questions to test students' understanding of digital literacy concepts. I also connected the form to Google Sheets to view and analyze responses.

This task helped me understand how coding platforms can improve logical thinking and programming skills, while tools like Google Forms can be used for data collection and collaboration. These tools are highly beneficial in academics, as they make it easier to conduct surveys, gather feedback, and organize information. Overall, this task enhanced my practical knowledge of digital platforms and their real-world applications.

Task 4

Task 4 focused on professional communication and email etiquette. I wrote two formal emails—one requesting an assignment deadline extension and another applying for a summer internship. This helped me understand the importance of clear subject lines, polite tone, and proper structure in emails.

I also created a social media do’s and don’ts checklist to promote responsible online behavior. A situation where poor digital communication can cause problems is when a student sends an email without a proper greeting or clear message, which may appear disrespectful or confusing.

Such issues can be avoided by following basic email etiquette, including clarity, politeness, and proper formatting. This task helped me realize that effective communication plays a crucial role in both academic and professional environments.

Task 5

In Task 5, I researched cybercrime with a focus on cyberbullying. I was surprised to learn how common and harmful online harassment can be, especially among students. Cyberbullying includes sending abusive messages, spreading rumors, or publicly shaming someone on social media platforms.

What I found most concerning is that it can have serious emotional and psychological effects on victims, such as stress, anxiety, and loss of confidence. Many cases go unreported because victims feel afraid or embarrassed.

This task made me more aware of the importance of responsible online behavior. One habit I will personally change is being more mindful of what I post or comment online and ensuring that my communication is always respectful. I will also support others who may be facing such issues and encourage reporting through proper channels.

Conclusion

This project provided me with valuable insights into digital literacy and its importance in modern life. Through the five tasks, I learned how to use digital tools effectively, build a professional online presence, communicate properly, and stay safe from cyber threats.

The hands-on experience gained from this project has improved my confidence in using technology for academic and professional purposes. It also helped me understand the responsibilities of being a digital citizen. Overall, this project has prepared me to use digital platforms responsibly and efficiently in the future.

References

- Canva (https://www.canva.com)
- Google Forms (https://forms.google.com)
- HackerRank (https://www.hackerrank.com)
- GitHub (https://github.com)
- LinkedIn (https://linkedin.com)
- National Cyber Crime Portal (https://cybercrime.gov.in)